

Petition 2 — Renewal / Review of the Parambikulam–Aliyar Project (PAP) Agreement and Realisation of Kerala's Assured Chitturpuzha Share

To: Shri Mons Joseph Hon'ble Minister for Water Resources (Irrigation, CADA & Ground Water), Government of Kerala
Thiruvananthapuram

Copy to: Shri V.D. Satheesan, Hon'ble Chief Minister of Kerala (holding the *Inter-State River Waters* portfolio)

From: The Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara, Chittur Taluk, Palakkad District — represented by
[Name, designation] and delegation.

Through: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur Constituency.

Date: 15 July 2026, Thiruvananthapuram.

Subject: Urgent renewal / review of the Parambikulam–Aliyar Project (PAP) agreement between Kerala and Tamil Nadu,
and guaranteed realisation of Kerala's assured water share for the Chitturpuzha valley.

1. Respected Sir,

The single most important lifeline for the farmers of the Chittur rain-shadow belt is the water of the **Chitturpuzha**, a tributary of the Bharathapuzha, fed under the inter-State **Parambikulam–Aliyar Project (PAP)** agreement with Tamil Nadu. We pray for the State's urgent intervention to renew this long-overdue agreement and to secure the water that is rightfully ours.

2. Why Chittur has no alternative

Chittur is the **eastern-most** agricultural tract of Kerala. Almost every river rising in the Western Ghats flows **westward**; **no west-flowing river can reach** the eastern panchayats of Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy and Kozhinjampara. Combined with the lowest rainfall in the State (about 1,000 mm against Kerala's ~3,000 mm average), this makes the assured release under the PAP agreement — chiefly through the **Manakadavu weir** into the Chitturpuzha and thence the **Moolathara barrage / Right Bank Canal** — the **only** dependable surface-water source for this region. The waters of the Chittur valley were historically developed to serve the Chittur tract of the erstwhile **Cochin (Kochi) State**; the command that this water must serve has since expanded well beyond that original region.

3. The agreement and its shortfall — the facts

- 1. The agreement.** The PAP agreement was signed between Kerala and Tamil Nadu on **29 May 1970**, with **retrospective effect from 9 November 1958**. Being an inter-State river-water matter, it falls within the framework of the **Inter-State River Water Disputes Act, 1956** and Entry 56 of the Union List / Article 262 of the Constitution — a subject held at the level of the **Hon'ble Chief Minister (Inter-State River Waters portfolio)**.
- 2. Renewal is decades overdue.** The agreement contains a clause for **review every 30 years**, i.e. it was **due for review in 1988**. Despite many rounds of official- and political-level talks, it **has still not been renewed** — a delay now of nearly four decades.
- 3. Kerala's assured share is not being received.** Under the agreement, Kerala is entitled to about **7,250 million cubic feet (≈ 7.25 TMC)** of water per water year (1 July – 10 June) at the **Manakadavu weir** for the Chitturpuzha, in addition to an entitlement of about **2.5 TMC from the Parambikulam group of reservoirs for the exclusive use of the Chitturpuzha valley**. In practice, actual releases fall far short: - In the **2023–24 water year**, Kerala received **only about 3,573 mcft** (as reported to the Assembly up to January 2024) — roughly **half** the assured 7,250 mcft. - The **Kerala Legislative Assembly Ad-hoc Committee on the Parambikulam–Mullaperiyar water-sharing agreement (Report, 1994)** recorded that Kerala had received only about **15.9 TMC against a due share of 41.75 TMC**.

4. **Structural cause.** Following the construction of the chain of PAP dams and diversions, the natural flow that once reached the Chitturpuzha valley has been substantially curtailed; assured flows at Manakadavu and Sholayar are not being honoured in low-yield years, and Tamil Nadu has proposed further diversions without Kerala's concurrence.

4. Our prayer

We humbly request the Hon'ble Minister, and through him the Hon'ble Chief Minister (who holds the Inter-State River Waters portfolio), to:

1. **Accord top priority to the renewal / review of the PAP agreement**, which has been overdue since 1988, and pursue it at the Chief-Minister level with Tamil Nadu.
2. **Insist on full realisation of the assured 7,250 mcft (7.25 TMC) at the Manakadavu weir**, with **telemetry / measuring stations and a transparent monitoring mechanism** to guarantee the flow, especially in the critical summer months and in low-yield years.
3. Press Tamil Nadu to **release water from the Parambikulam reservoir to Aliyar and onward to Manakadavu**, and to honour the 2.5 TMC exclusive Chitturpuzha-valley entitlement.
4. **Reconstitute and reconvene the joint (secretary-level) Kerala–Tamil Nadu committee**; and, should Tamil Nadu remain unresponsive, examine recourse to a **statutory tribunal / Union Government (Ministry of Jal Shakti) mediation** under the inter-State river-water framework.
5. **Complete and extend the Moolathara Right Bank Canal micro-irrigation project** so that the assured water actually reaches the tail-end fields of Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy and Kozhinjampara.

5. Annexures (to be attached)

- Annexure A: Copy of the 1970 PAP agreement (relevant clauses).
- Annexure B: Year-wise data of assured vs. actual releases at Manakadavu weir.
- Annexure C: Map of the Chitturpuzha command and the eastern panchayats.

Respectfully submitted,

For and on behalf of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara

[Name, Designation] [Phone / Email]

Endorsed by: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur

Annexure — Draft Government Order (model, for the Government's consideration)

The following is a model draft placed for the Government's consideration. The actual G.O. number, date and file references are to be assigned by the Department.

GOVERNMENT OF KERALA
Abstract

Water Resources Department — Parambikulam–Aliyar Project (PAP) inter-State agreement dated 29-05-1970 with Tamil Nadu — Review/renewal (due since 1988) and realisation of Kerala's assured Chitturpuzha share at Manakadavu weir — Constitution of negotiating committee and installation of telemetry — Orders issued.

WATER RESOURCES (INTER-STATE WATERS) DEPARTMENT
G.O.(Ms) No. ____/2026/WRD Thiruvananthapuram, dated __-__-2026

Read: 1. The Parambikulam–Aliyar Project agreement dated 29-05-1970 (effective 09-11-1958), Article on review after 30 years.

2. Report (1994) of the Kerala Legislative Assembly Ad-hoc Committee on the Parambikulam–Mullaperiyar agreement.
3. The Inter-State River Water Disputes Act, 1956.
4. Representation dated 15-07-2026 of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara, forwarded by the MLA, Chittur.

ORDER

Whereas the review of the PAP agreement, due after 30 years (i.e. in 1988), remains pending; and whereas Kerala's assured entitlement of 7,250 mcft (≈7.25 TMC) at the Manakadavu weir for the Chitturpuzha is not being realised (only ≈3,573 mcft received in the 2023–24 water year);

Government, having considered the matter, hereby order that —

- (1) the State shall accord top priority, at the Chief-Minister level, to the review/renewal of the PAP agreement with the Government of Tamil Nadu;
- (2) a Kerala–Tamil Nadu joint (Secretary-level) negotiating committee shall be (re)constituted to conclude the review within a time-bound schedule;
- (3) the Water Resources Department shall install telemetry/measuring stations at the Manakadavu weir and Sholayar to verify and guarantee the assured flows, including in low-yield years and summer months;
- (4) the State shall press for the 2.5 TMC exclusive Chitturpuzha-valley share and, failing a favourable response, examine recourse to the Union Government / a statutory tribunal under the Act read above (3); and
- (5) the Moolathara Right Bank Canal micro-irrigation extension serving Eruthempathy/Vadakarapathy/Kozhinjampara shall be expedited.

By order of the Governor,

Secretary to Government

To The Chief Secretary; the Principal Secretary, Water Resources.

Copy to: the Hon'ble Chief Minister's Office (Inter-State River Waters); the Chief Engineer (IDRB); the MLA, Chittur.